

Mercury Perihelion Precession: Historical Timeline

Le Verrier reports
43"/century anomaly

1859

Newcomb: 43.37"/century
no Newtonian explanation

1895

Eddington: light
bending confirms GR

1919

1879

Simon Newcomb
refined measurement

1915

Einstein: GR predicts
exactly 43"/century

1972

Radar ranging: GR
confirmed to 0.1%

